

Counterinsurgency (COIN) Operations Following Operation Herof 2.0

KEY FINDINGS

The Baloch Liberation Army (BLA) has executed its most complex offensive to date, designated “Operation Herof 2.0”, utilizing a swarm tactic across 12 districts to overwhelm provincial Quick Reaction Forces (QRF).

The Pakistani state response, executed under the Operation Azm-e-Istekham framework, has been successful, with officials claiming 145-200 militants KIA (as of 4 FEB 2026). However, the successful BLA attacks and the delayed response indicate a significant intelligence failure regarding early warning and infiltration.

A significantly more active use of female combatants in direct assault roles has been noticed, in contrast to a more passive, noncombatant, or strictly suicide bombing role in previous attacks.

Pakistani Interior Minister has blamed India for the attacks, claiming that the attacks were too well coordinated for it to have been an independent effort.

SITUATION REPORT

Between 30 January and 2 February 2026, BLA militants launched a multi-vector offensive targeting security installations, communication nodes, and logistics infrastructure across Baluchistan. The group utilized an infiltration-activation tactic seen multiple times in similar attacks in South Asia, taking advantage of lax regional security and low access barriers.

Regions targeted by BLA are Quetta, Mastung, Noshki, Dalbandin, Kharan, Panjgur, Tump, Gwadar, and Pasni. Conventional small arms and suicide vests were used in the attacks, targeting residential areas, security infrastructure, and dense public hubs in a coordinate effort. The operation was officially designated as “Herof 2.0”, a reference to the August 2024 attacks (labeled as Operation Herof). The attack resulted in 17-84 (as of 4 FEB 2026) casualties, 32-50 of which were civilians.

Following the attack, Pakistani Security Forces (Army, Frontier Corps, Counterterrorism) conducted a 40-hour search and elimination operation under the Operation Azm-e-Istehkam framework. Official reports claim 145-200 militants killed in action (KIA), while the security forces casualties range from 17 to 84. As is the nature of conflicts in the region, casualty reports are rarely accurate immediately following the operation. The counteroffensive was executed in both urban search-and-destroy formats and targeted assault formats into known rural staging areas.

ADDITIONAL DETAILS

Following are critical details rising from both official and unofficial (OSINT) sources.

There is a concern in the marginally high number of female suicide bombers used in the initial attacks. While it is not uncommon for South Asian groups to utilize female operatives for security bypass, the number of footages and reports of all-female squads and fireteams is highly unusual. Some, including Asifa Mengal and Hawa Baloch, both in their early 20s, have been reported to have been indoctrinated together, the latter being a daughter of a former BLA fighter KIA in 2021.

<https://x.com/i/status/2017993194345030003>

<https://x.com/i/status/2018090461496332448>

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<https://x.com/i/status/2018100961592344665>

<https://x.com/mediahamasa/status/2018293385262457281>

At the tail end of the clearance operation in Baluchistan, an additional BLA attack was reported in Zehri. A total of 16 militants in the area were neutralized.

https://x.com/War_Analysts/status/2018625072735703133

On 4 FEB 2026, a coordinated attack on an ISIS-K Facility was reported, resulting in 11 ISKP casualties. Most of the deceased appear to be foreign national members who consolidated following a kinetic strike.

<https://x.com/i/status/2018742307911094716>

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